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Renter Winter Checklist

12 quick jobs to do before the first freeze. Check them off and stick this on the fridge.

- [ ] **Find the main water shutoff** and test that you can turn it. Label it with tape.
- [ ] **Find the breaker panel.** Make sure the circuit labels are readable.
- [ ] **Test smoke and CO alarms.** Swap batteries if that's your job; report hardwired units that fail.
- [ ] **Replace the HVAC filter** if your lease makes it your job. Write the date on the frame.
- [ ] **Disconnect garden hoses** from outdoor spigots before the first freeze.
- [ ] **Freezing nights:** open cabinet doors under sinks on outside walls so warm air reaches the pipes.
- [ ] **Hard freezes:** let the faucets on outside walls drip slowly.
- [ ] **Away for the holidays?** Keep the heat on. Many guides say 55°F or higher.
- [ ] **Check windows and doors for drafts.** Use removable fixes (draft snakes, rope caulk) or ask before using adhesive.
- [ ] **Space heaters:** keep them 3 ft from anything that can burn, plug straight into the wall, and turn them off when you leave.
- [ ] **Report heating problems in writing now**, before the cold snap. Keep a copy.
- [ ] **Save the emergency maintenance number** in your phone, and check your renters insurance.

Want the full kit? The Renter's Winter Kit adds a move-in photo log, a room-by-room inspection, a move-out deposit checklist, a maintenance request log and a shutoff map. Link on the RenterFix channel page.